

Jakob Zapanta

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EDUCATION

Tufts University, Medford, MA

Expected Graduation: May 2028

Major in Mechanical Engineering, Minor in Astrophysics

GPA: 3.53, Dean's List Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Completed Coursework: Astrophysics Lab, Physics E&M, Calculus III, Seminar for Learning Assistants in STEM, Mechanics Statics, Materials & Manufacturing

Spring 2026 Coursework: Intro to Modern Physics, Differential Equations, Thermal Fluid Systems, Mechanics Dynamics

WORK EXPERIENCE

Tufts University Physics Dept., Medford, MA

Sep 2025 — Present

Physics 2 Learning Assistant, Physics 11 Learning Assistant

- Facilitate productive and diverse dialogue among 20 students in lecture and recitation
- Discuss and refine facilitation techniques in weekly meetings and seminars, with a focus on dialogic listening, and supporting physics-based intuition

The Sink Coffee Shop, Medford, MA

Sep 2024 — Present

Barista

- Serve food and craft quality drinks for customers, including specialty and seasonal drinks
- Handle transactions and create a warm environment through cheerful customer interactions
- Clean shop, restock supplies, perform other misc. shift duties

EXTRACURRICULARS

Tufts University Robotics Club, Medford, MA

Sep 2024 — Present

Treasurer

Sep 2025 — Present

- Manage a \$30k annual university-awarded budget, ensuring compliance of all club expenditures
- Organize, document, and sign off on all club purchases and reimbursements

Battlebots Competitor

Sep 2024 — Apr 2025

- Designed and fabricated a 3lb combat robot on a four-person team
- Competed in the National Havoc Robotics League, and in an internal club competition

Filipino Young Global Leadership Program, The Philippines

Apr 2023 — Jul 2023

Pioneer Cohort Member

- Selected as one of 20 US high school students to participate in a program to enhance leadership skills and cultural identity
- Workshopped leadership skills through one-on-one sessions with a Clifton Strengths specialist

STEAM Demonstrations, Bridgeport, CT

Mar 2023 — Apr 2023

- Showcased robots to elementary schools by collaborating with a local science program to inspire students to pursue STEM education

SKILLS

Programming: Python, Markdown, LaTeX, Jupyter Notebook

Software: Solidworks CAD and FEM analysis, Blender

Manufacturing: 3D Printing, Sheet metal working, Sand casting, Injection molding